

The Boundary of Peace

50–55 min · January Week 3

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR
AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish boundaries from walls, identify one relationship needing a boundary, and practice the Calling-In Language structure.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills (primary) · Self-Management (supporting)
DURATION	50–55 min · January Week 3
KEY VOCABULARY	boundary · wall · open door · self-respect · calling-in language · consequence · fawn pattern
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Scenario Cards B4-17A, B4-17B · Boundary Language Cards B4-U3-BLC
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: forgiveness vs. reconciliation. Can you forgive someone fully and still choose not to restore the relationship?' [Answer.] 'Today: what do healthy limits actually look like?'

ILLINOIS SEL ALIGNMENT GRADES 9–10 · EARLY HIGH SCHOOL

Goal 2 — Social Awareness & Interpersonal Skills

2D.4b Analyze how conflict-resolution skills contribute to work within a group.

Goal 1 — Self-Awareness & Self-Management

1A.4b Generate ways to develop more positive attitudes.

Aligned to the Illinois Social/Emotional Learning Standards (ISBE).

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Students examine relationships where limits are needed — may include family relationships. Counselor on standby same day. Standard opt-out protocols. **CRITICAL:** Boundary-setting language must never be offered as a substitute for safety planning when a student is describing a situation involving genuine danger. Follow disclosure protocol immediately for any

safety situation.

NOTE

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND: CALLING-IN LANGUAGE — REPAIR-FOCUSED CONFRONTATION · Touchpoint 3 of 5 PLACEMENT: Embed immediately after DI Step 2 (Boundary vs. Wall vs. Open Door) — before pair practice. TIME: 6–8 minutes. Protected. Distribute Boundary Language Cards B4-U3-BLC during Step C. STEP A — NAME THE SKILL (1 min): 'This is called Calling-In Language. Direct, private, repair-focused. Four-part structure. We learn it right now.' STEP B — TEACH THE STRUCTURE (2 min). Write on board: (1) When you ___ [specific behavior — not character] (2) The impact on me was ___ [first-person, specific] (3) What I need going forward is ___ [specific, behavioral — the boundary] (4) I am telling you this because ___ [name your investment in the relationship] Step 4 separates calling-in from confrontation — it names why the person is worth the conversation. STEP C — DISTRIBUTE BOUNDARY LANGUAGE CARDS (30 sec): Cards B4-U3-BLC — six sentence-starter cards for each part of the structure. 'These are frames — the exact words must be genuinely yours.' STEP D — TEACHER MODELS (1 min): Use a generic appropriate example. Narrate each step aloud. STEP E — STUDENTS PRACTICE (90 sec): Apply to scenario card B4-17A or own situation — privately in journals. STEP F — ANCHOR AND POST (30 sec): Post the four-part structure on the anchor chart. TEACHING TIP: Frame as a relationship skill. 'Calling in is an act of respect — for yourself and for them.' Common error: students treating the structure as a script to recite verbatim. It is a framework.

ANCHOR CHART

BOUNDARY WHAT
I NEED TO STAY
IN RELATIONSHIP
WITH YOU CLEAR
· SPECIFIC FROM
SELF-RESPECT

WALL TOTAL
CLOSURE NO
OPENING FROM
FEAR PROTECTS
BUT ISOLATES

OPEN DOOR NO
CONDITIONS NO
SELF-
PROTECTION
FROM NEED OR
FEAR NOT A
BOUNDARY — A
WOUND

OPENING RITUAL

90 seconds 'Both feet on the floor. One breath slower than usual.' [Pause 10 seconds.] 'Last lesson: forgiveness does not require reconciliation. Today: what does reconciliation actually require — and what do you do when you're not ready to reconcile but still have to be in a relationship with someone? Today: the boundary of peace.' [Post: 'What is the difference between protecting yourself with a boundary and protecting yourself with a wall?']

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE During Step 3, a student who describes a family relationship — parent, sibling, or caregiver — with specific, detailed, present-tense description of what is happening.

MAY SIGNAL This student may be navigating a genuinely unsafe or harmful relational dynamic at home. Calling-in language is not the appropriate tool for unsafe family situations.

ACTION Do not offer boundary-setting language as the primary tool during the lesson. After class: 'I want to make sure I understand what you're describing. Can you tell me more?' If the situation involves ongoing harm or safety risk — follow disclosure protocol immediately. |

SCENARIO CARDS · FACILITATION NOTES

B4-17A and B4-17B B4-17A (YUSUF AND HIS FRIEND): Whole-class. Key: 'Is Yusuf's response a boundary or a wall? Write Yusuf's boundary statement using the Calling-In Language structure.' B4-17B (PRIYA AND HER STUDY GROUP): Pairs. Key: 'Priya has been the open door for three months. What does a boundary look like in that group context? Apply Calling-In Language.'

GRADE-BAND DIFFERENTIATION

GRADES 9 · 10	GRADES 11 · 12
Grades 9–10: Most important distinction: boundary from self-respect vs. attempt to control. Fawn connection is crucial — name it explicitly: 'Setting a boundary will feel like conflict if your dominant pattern is fawn. That feeling is not evidence the boundary is wrong. It is evidence the pattern is being challenged.'	Grades 11–12: Connect to adult contexts — 'In college, workplaces, adult relationships — people who cannot set limits become the people everyone brings problems to, until they have nothing left. Sustainable relationships require sustainable limits.' Connects to B5-U3-L3.

EXIT TICKET

"The difference between a boundary and a wall is ___. One relationship where I need a boundary is ___. The specific limit is ___. I am setting it from ___ [self-respect / retaliation]." Journal — private. Never collected. Never graded.

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

LEGAL / PPRA NOTE ★ PPRA-DESIGNATED. Disclosure of relationships where limits are needed — may include family. Counselor on standby same day. **CRITICAL:** Boundary-setting language must never substitute for safety planning. Follow disclosure protocol for any safety situation.

TEACHER REFLECTION

Most clinically sensitive standard lesson in Book 4. The scan protocol here is the most important scan of Unit 3 — a student describing an unsafe family dynamic needs immediate counselor involvement, not boundary-setting coaching. After this lesson: brief counselor on any students who appeared to be describing situations beyond peer conflict scope.

FAMILY CONNECTION · CONVERSATION STARTER

L3: THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE · ★ PPRA Dear Families, Today students learned about boundaries — a specific limit set from self-respect, with a specific consequence for the person setting it. A boundary controls only yourself — it describes what you will do if a limit is crossed, not what the other person is allowed to do. Students also learned the Calling-In Language structure: a four-part framework for naming harm in a direct, private, relationship-preserving way. Conversation-starter: 'Is there a relationship in your life where you give more than you receive — and does that feel sustainable to you?'

► DIRECT INSTRUCTION

Scripted teaching sequence · Steps 1 — 3 · read aloud or in your own words

01 BOUNDARY VS. WALL VS. OPEN DOOR**8 MIN**

Post the three-column chart. 'An open door gives unlimited access. A wall closes all access. A boundary: a specific limit, clearly communicated, with a specific consequence.' Write: BOUNDARY = specific limit + clear communication + specific consequence. 'A boundary controls only you. A boundary says: if this continues, here is what I will do. It makes no claim on what they are allowed to do.' Ask: 'Why is that distinction important?'

02 FROM RETALIATION TO SELF-RESPECT**8 MIN**

Write: FROM RETALIATION: You can't do that. FROM SELF-RESPECT: If that continues, here is what I will do. 'Yusuf's boundary is from self-respect — not trying to punish his friend, describing what he will do with his own time and energy going forward. His friend can cancel as many times as they choose. Yusuf's boundary describes his response, not their permitted behavior.' [DELIVER R&R STRAND TOUCHPOINT 3 HERE — see Calling-In Language strand block above]

03 WHAT THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE ACTUALLY COSTS

6 MIN

'Setting a boundary will feel wrong at first — especially if your dominant pattern is fawn. Because you have been rewarded for keeping the peace. The Boundary of Peace is not the absence of discomfort. It is the maintenance of your integrity under pressure.' Students write privately: 'One relationship where I need a boundary rather than an open door or a wall is _____. The specific limit is _____.'

SCENARIO CARDS

Print and laminate before unit. Two cards per lesson.

B4-17A THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE
DISCLOSURE**

** ★★ HIGH

THE SITUATION

After two years of working to forgive her former best friend — who had shared a private confidence that damaged Ryn's reputation — Ryn has reached a genuine place of internal release. She doesn't carry the resentment anymore. She does not trust her former friend. She does not want the friendship back. When people ask if they are 'okay now,' Ryn says: 'I'm at peace with it.' They assume that means reconciliation. It doesn't.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

What has Ryn done internally — and what has she chosen not to do externally? Why can both be true at once? People assume 'at peace with it' means the relationship is restored. What does their assumption reveal about how most people understand forgiveness? Ryn doesn't trust her former friend. Does the absence of reconciliation mean the forgiveness isn't real? Write the boundary Ryn has set — in her own words — as a statement of self-protection, not punishment.

FORGIVENESS WITHOUT RECONCILIATION *Forgiveness is an internal act — releasing resentment for your own peace. Reconciliation is relational — restoring a damaged connection. These are two separate things. You can fully forgive someone without ever resuming the relationship. The boundary Ryn has set is not a punishment. It is a self-protective limit set from clarity, not bitterness.*

B4-17B THE BOUNDARY OF PEACE
DISCLOSURE**

** ★★ HIGH

THE SITUATION

Yusuf's uncle has apologized sincerely for missing key events in Yusuf's childhood — he had a substance use disorder that has since been addressed. He is genuinely different now. The extended family expects Yusuf to 'let it go' and resume the close relationship that never quite existed. Yusuf is choosing to release the resentment — and he is not ready to be close. His aunt tells him he is 'being unforgiving.' He is actually forgiving.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

What is Yusuf's aunt misunderstanding — and what would you say to her? Yusuf is doing the internal work of releasing resentment. What is he not doing — and why is that a separate choice? The uncle has genuinely changed. Does genuine change obligate Yusuf to trust? Why or why not? What is the difference between the boundary Yusuf is maintaining and withholding forgiveness?

TRUST IS REBUILT, NOT RESTORED *Trust is a relational resource. It requires demonstrated change over time, genuine safety, and the willingness of both parties to invest in rebuilding. It is never obligatory — not even after genuine growth. Yusuf's uncle's recovery is real. His right to Yusuf's trust must be rebuilt — it cannot be resumed simply because the behavior that damaged it has changed. Forgiveness and trust are two different journeys, on two different timelines.*

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · BOOK 4 · THE FAÇADE (9–10)

Boundary · Wall · Open Door

Unit 3

GRACE

BOUNDARY

- What I need to stay in relationship with you
- Clear · specific
- From self-respect

WALL

- Total closure · no opening
- From fear
- Protects but isolates

OPEN DOOR

- No conditions · no self-protection
- From need or fear
- Not a boundary — a wound

A wall protects but isolates. An open door is not a boundary — it is a wound.

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE

This is a free preview.

Sample Lesson · Book 4 · The Façade (9–10)

The complete, classroom-ready curriculum — with anchor charts, worksheets, Illinois SEL alignment, and scripted Direct Instruction — is part of the Architecture of Grace district library. Educators can license the full set; families can find materials in the family store.

architectureofgrace.org